CHURN IS DEAD

The Off-Telemetry Map Audit

Sort your last 12 months of enterprise churn — and score how early a human could have caught what the model missed.

> Your health score measures product reality. Renewals get decided in org charts, budget meetings, and private peer conversations your stack will never reach. This audit forces you to separate the churn your telemetry can see from the churn it never could — and to grade your own coverage of the second half.

Scoring: Rate each item 1-5. 1 = not happening, 5 = embedded in operations. Score your team honestly against your last 12 months of enterprise losses.

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Source: churnisdead.com
Version: 1.0 -- June 2026

SECTION 1

1. In-Product Signals (What Your Stack Already Sees — And Over-Trusts)

These signals are real and useful, but complete only within their own frame. The trap is mistaking a deeply-adopted, green account for a renewal forecast when budget authority can evaporate underneath active usage.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Health score treated as one input of four	Product telemetry is explicitly weighted as ~25% of renewal confidence; never the verdict	Health score IS the renewal forecast; green means safe, full stop
Audited green-at-churn losses	You've pulled every account that churned while green and named the off-telemetry root cause	No one has reviewed how many lost deals were green at notice
Champion-vs-authority separation	You track whether the power user logging in actually holds budget authority	Power-user engagement is read as account safety
Telemetry confidence calibration	Team knows what the model's accuracy is accurate ABOUT — telemetry-visible churn only	Vendor's '85% accuracy' is trusted as total churn coverage
Documented telemetry blind spots	A written list of decisions the product graph structurally cannot see	Assumption that rising usage covers all renewal risk

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Health score is explicitly one of four inputs, not the renewal verdict	1-5
You have audited which past losses were green at notice	1-5
You distinguish product engagement from budget authority	1-5
Team understands the limits of what telemetry measures	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 2

2. Org-Chart Signals (Reorgs, Champion Moves, New Skeptical Execs)

A customer's internal restructure never shows up in how they log into your software. A new CFO four months before notice was the single most predictive signal in a seven-figure loss — and the stack generated zero from it.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Named-contact monitoring	Sales Navigator alerts on every named contact and C-suite seat in top 50 accounts	You learn about a champion's exit from their out-of-office reply
New-exec early warning	A new CFO, CIO, or VP of Strategy triggers an account review within a week	Leadership changes go unnoticed until they affect the renewal
Weekly review discipline	Someone reads org-chart alerts every Monday and logs the implications	Alerts exist but no one is assigned to act on them
Champion redundancy	Every top account has 2+ mapped champions across functions	Account safety rests on a single relationship
Org-event-to-risk linkage	Reorgs and title changes feed directly into renewal risk scoring	Org events live in LinkedIn and never reach the CS workflow

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
You have automated alerts on contacts and execs in top accounts	1-5
New executives trigger a structured account review	1-5
A named owner reviews org-chart signals weekly	1-5
Champion coverage is mapped and redundant	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 3

3. Budget-and-Priority Signals (AI Reallocation, Freezes, M&A;)

Most seven-figure surprises originate here — in a P&L; you'll never see and a meeting you're not in. When a board funds an AI program by trimming the vendor stack, your product can be flawless and you still lose the line.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Budget-cycle awareness	You know each top account's fiscal year, planning window, and board cadence	You discover budget timing only when notice arrives
Vendor-consolidation watch	M&A;, funding events, and AI initiatives at customers are tracked as standardization risk	Acquisitions and consolidation reviews surprise the CSM
Category-fit framing	You can articulate whether your product is a 'fund' or a 'cut' in the customer's strategy	Renewal pitch assumes product quality settles the decision
Economic-buyer access	CSMs have a live relationship with whoever controls the spend, not just the user	Only end-users are known; the budget owner is a stranger
AI-reallocation tracking	You monitor when customers publicly commit to AI bets that compete for budget	AI initiatives are treated as unrelated to your renewal

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
You know the budget cycle and board cadence of top accounts	1-5
M&A; and consolidation events are tracked as churn risk	1-5
You can name whether your product is a fund-or-cut line item	1-5
CSMs have access to the actual economic buyer	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 4

4. Sentiment-of-Record Signals (What the Buyer Says to Peers, Not to You)

> The NPS 9 from a power user tells you what one user thinks. It says nothing about what your buyer says about you in private peer conversations and analyst calls — the sentiment that actually shapes the consolidation decision.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Distinguishing user vs buyer sentiment	You separate what users tell you from what the buyer tells peers	A high NPS from a power user is read as account-wide confidence
Peer-network signal	You tap community, analyst, and peer-group chatter about the account	Your only sentiment data is what the customer says to your face
Reference-willingness as a probe	Willingness (or refusal) to be a public reference is tracked as a sentiment signal	Reference requests are made but declines aren't logged as risk
Skeptic identification	You know who in the account is unconvinced and what they say to their boss	You only hear from your fans; skeptics are invisible
Off-the-record listening	QBRs and check-ins deliberately surface unspoken doubts and competitor mentions	Conversations confirm the relationship instead of stress-testing it

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
You separate end-user sentiment from buyer sentiment	1-5
You gather signal from peer networks and analysts	1-5
Reference willingness and skeptics are tracked	1-5
Check-ins are designed to surface unspoken doubt	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

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Your Scorecard

Dimension	Your Score	Max
1. 1. In-Product Signals (What Your Stack Already Sees — And Over-Trusts)	____	5
2. 2. Org-Chart Signals (Reorgs, Champion Moves, New Skeptical Execs)	____	5
3. 3. Budget-and-Priority Signals (AI Reallocation, Freezes, M&A;)	____	5
4. 4. Sentiment-of-Record Signals (What the Buyer Says to Peers, Not to You)	____	5
TOTAL	____	20

Total Score	Assessment	What It Means
16-20	Uncuttable	Embedded, measurable, strategically irreplaceable.
12-15	Defensible	Solid but gaps remain. Focus on lowest dimension.
8-11	Vulnerable	Real risk ahead. Treat as urgent.
4-7	Critical	Cannot survive scrutiny. Major changes needed.

What to do next: Take your lowest-scoring section and build a 30-day action plan. One at a time. Then share this with leadership -- not to ask permission, but to show you know where the gaps are.

Automating the scorecard doesn't reduce the blindness. It industrializes it.

-- Kuber

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